

DIGI-FIN LITERACY AFRICA

Digital Privacy Quick Guide

5 essential steps to protect your phone, your data, and your money in Africa's digital economy.

FREE DOWNLOAD | 5 pages

digifinliteracyafrica@gmail.com | [@digi.fin.literacy.africa](https://www.instagram.com/digi.fin.literacy.africa)

Why Your Privacy = Your Money

Your phone holds more financial data than a bank vault — your M-Pesa PIN, banking credentials, National ID details, transaction history, and contact list. A single privacy breach can drain your accounts in minutes. This guide gives you five actionable layers of protection, from today to ongoing.

Threat	How It Works	Risk Level
Phishing SMS/Email	Fake messages impersonate Safaricom or your bank to steal your PIN/OTP	■ HIGH
SIM Swap Fraud	Fraudster uses your ID details to port your number, intercepts all SMS/calls	■ HIGH
Social Engineering	Caller poses as customer care, manipulates you into revealing credentials	■ HIGH
Malware Apps	Fake free apps harvest keystrokes, contacts, and financial data silently	■ MEDIUM
Oversharing Online	Public posts (salary, ID, location) give fraudsters targeting data	■ MEDIUM

■ The Golden Rule

Your bank, Safaricom, or any legitimate financial institution will NEVER ask for your OTP, PIN, or full password — by call, SMS, or email. If anyone asks: hang up and call back on the official number.

The 5 Layers of Digital Privacy

Layer 1 — Lock Your Entry Points

Enable a SIM card PIN (not the same as your screen lock). Set a strong screen lock — fingerprint or a 6-digit PIN. These two steps stop most physical theft attacks cold.

Tip

SIM lock: Settings → SIM Card → Lock SIM Screen lock: Settings → Security → Screen Lock

Layer 2 — Secure Every Account

Use a unique, strong password (12+ characters) for each financial platform. Never reuse your M-Pesa PIN as a password elsewhere. Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) on your email and banking apps — this blocks 99% of account takeover attempts.

Tip

Enable 2FA: Settings → Security on each app, or use Google Authenticator

Layer 3 — Audit Your Apps

Many apps ask for permissions they do not need. A flashlight app should not need your contacts. A game should not need your location. Review monthly and revoke anything unnecessary.

Tip

Check: Settings → Apps → [App Name] → Permissions

Layer 4 — Guard Your Data Online

Remove your phone number, ID number, and salary details from public social media profiles. Avoid posting real-time location updates or travel plans — this signals when you are away. Never share photos of your ID or financial documents in WhatsApp groups.

Tip

Quick audit: Search your own name on Google and see what appears

Layer 5 — Know the Fraud Playbook

Legitimate contacts never create panic and urgency. If a message says 'act now or lose your account,' that urgency is the scam. Always verify through the official number on Safaricom's website (not the number that called you).

Tip

Official Safaricom fraud line: 100 (free call, 24/7)

Your Privacy Protection Checklist

Work through these three levels. Start with Level 1 today — it takes under 10 minutes.

LEVEL 1 — Do This Today (10 min)

- Enable SIM card PIN lock on your phone
- Set a screen lock (fingerprint or 6-digit PIN)
- Enable 2FA on your primary email account
- Change your M-Pesa PIN if unchanged in 3+ months
- Save Safaricom fraud line: 100 in your contacts

LEVEL 2 — Complete This Week

- Enable 2FA on your mobile banking app
- Audit app permissions — revoke anything unnecessary
- Delete apps you no longer use (especially those with financial access)
- Remove phone number and ID details from public social media profiles
- Turn off location sharing for apps that don't require it

LEVEL 3 — Ongoing Monthly Habits

- Review M-Pesa and bank statements for unauthorised transactions
- Check app permissions and revoke any that have crept back in
- Think before you post: does this reveal income, routine, or identity details?
- Never use public Wi-Fi for banking or M-Pesa transactions
- Back up important documents securely (not just on your phone)

Real Story + Your Privacy Action

number with an unknown caller claiming to be from Safaricom. Two — her ID number (shared publicly for an online competition) was ours, her M-Pesa and linked bank accounts lost KSh 43,000.

⇒ 5-Minute Privacy Audit

1. Open your Instagram (or Facebook) profile as a stranger — tap 'View Profile'. Write down every piece of personal information visible. Date of birth? Phone number? Employer? Neighbourhood?
2. Remove anything that could help a fraudster answer your security questions or craft a targeted message.
3. Go to Settings → Apps on your phone. Identify ONE app with unnecessary permissions and revoke them now.
4. Add this contact: Safaricom Fraud = 100. Done? Tick it off.

Report Digital Finance Complaints in Kenya

Safaricom Fraud Line	100 (free call)
Communications Authority	complaints@ca.go.ke
Central Bank of Kenya	consumerprotection@centralbank.go.ke
DCI Cybercrime Unit	cybercrime@dcg.go.ke

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